

“Be bold, and make the decision to take a more active role in at least one FOSS project over the next month.”

John Quincy

Adams, the sixth president of the United States, once said: “If your actions inspire others to dream more, learn more, do more and become more, you are a leader.”

Jared Smith, Fedora Project leader, is one such exemplary person who has led and motivated several communities, groups, teams, and individuals in the open source ecosystem. He has helped them to learn, evolve and contribute, meaningfully, to the pool of open source resources. Vandana Sharma of LINUX For You bureau caught up with Smith to learn about the principles and practices that have driven and inspired him over the years in his career as an open source practitioner and evangelist.

In this interview he also talks about his role at the helm of the Fedora Project, the future of Linux and open source, his expectations from the next generation of developers, and the relevance of their role in shaping the future of free software.

Most importantly, he tells us what's new and exciting in 'Verne', the 16th edition of the Fedora distribution, released on November 8, 2011.